



KUNAL SHANTILAL

Product Designer • Melbourne

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about me.

I started my career writing code alongside design, which shaped how I think - understanding how things get built has made me a sharper problem solver. I've worked across the full spectrum: building from zero as a founding designer at a startup, and operating at scale at Xero where my work on iOS and Android reached 500k+ active users. Startups taught me to move fast and own everything. Xero taught me to move carefully and think at scale. Through both, I've learned that getting close to the problem and the people it affects is what separates design that looks good from design that actually makes an impact.

experience.

KudoSync.ai – Founding Product Designer (Freelance)

Jan 2025 – Present - Remote

Founding designer on a B2B SaaS product built from scratch - owning everything from defining what gets built first to how it looks, feels, and scales across web and mobile. The product is currently in development and not yet released, so details are limited.

- Built the product's visual foundation in Figma - defining a colour and typography design system and implementing it into a codebase-aligned component library
- Defined product prioritisation in a greenfield environment - distinguishing high-impact foundational features from nice-to-haves and translating them into wireframes, user flows, and a sequenced roadmap
- Created a product vision and presented design decisions to major shareholders, framing direction to build investor confidence and alignment
- Collaborate daily with CEO and Lead Engineer as a founding trio - shaping product direction while working across disciplines without silos

Xero – Product Designer

Dec 2021 - Jul 2025 - Melbourne

Native mobile product designer on Xero's flagship Accounting App. I designed and delivering high-impact iOS and Android experiences for 500k+ active small businesses globally. Led medium to large-scale initiatives end-to-end in a fast-paced, constantly evolving environment, adapting quickly to shifting business priorities while managing stakeholder relationships across Product, Engineering, and senior leadership.

Key projects

Invoice onboarding & template set up

- Owned interaction and experience design for the Create & Send Invoice and Invoice Template Setup flows within Guided Setup - enabling capabilities previously only available on web
- Led end-to-end user research and experimentation: Planning and running unmoderated usability tests in UserTesting.com, drawing on MixPanel usage data to validate designs and identify friction
- Partnered with Lead Designer, PMs, Engineers, and Analytics to define task structure, success metrics, and completion logic
- Designed reusable Figma components aligned with the mobile design system for consistency, accessibility (WCAG), and cross-platform scalability

Impact

- +7.66% uplift in 14-day invoice sending for users exposed to the mobile onboarding experience
- 35% task completion rate on mobile vs 20% on equivalent web experience
- 40% of users who completed invoice template setup went on to send an invoice

Mobile Navigation Redesign (Released May 2026)

- Owned navigation and interaction design for a global, app-wide mobile navigation redesign across iOS and Android
- Contributed to research activities that validated the information architecture, translating insights into scalable native navigation patterns
- Drove early clarity in an ambiguous problem space - working closely with PMs and Engineers to establish direction and maintain momentum
- Coordinated across web counterparts and multiple mobile teams, mapping affected areas and facilitating alignment through workshops
- Contributed to system-level navigation decisions improving consistency, accessibility, and future scalability of the mobile experience

Impact

- Improved wayfinding and feature discoverability across high-frequency mobile workflows
- Reduced cognitive load by simplifying navigation and interaction patterns, enabling faster access to key actions
- Established a more consistent navigation experience across mobile and web, laying the foundation for future product growth

WhosOnLocation - Digital Designer / UX/UI Designer / Front-end Developer

2017 - 2021 - Wellington, New Zealand

Joined as a Digital Designer and grew into a hybrid role spanning UX design and front-end development - taking on increasing ownership across product design, marketing, and engineering at a growing B2B SaaS startup.

- Led UX and UI design for a B2B web application used by global customers - owning the end-to-end process from wireframes and user flows through to high-fidelity Figma prototypes
- Owned the global website redesign end-to-end, the flagship project of my time there - taking it from concept through to build and launch
- Contributed to and evolved the product design system, improving consistency across the platform and scaling new features
- Contributed front-end development alongside design work (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, CMS theming), building a strong foundation for design-engineering collaboration
- Collaborated across product, engineering, sales, and support to translate complex requirements into usable, scalable solutions
- Supported go-to-market initiatives by designing feature release assets, marketing collateral, and partner-facing materials

skills.

Tools: Figma, FigJam, Miro, AI tools (Claude, Claude Design, ChatGPT), HTML, CSS, JavaScript (working knowledge)

Design: Native mobile design (iOS / Android), design systems, UX/UI, interaction design, prototyping, wireframing, accessibility (WCAG)

Research: User research, usability testing, unmoderated testing, A/B testing, analytics-informed design

Collaboration: Cross-functional collaboration, agile/Scrum, design-engineering handoff, stakeholder presentations

education.

- **Bachelor of Design Innovation: 2013 - 2015**

Major: Media design
Victoria University of Wellington

- **Diploma of Web & UX Design: 2017**

Yoobee School of Design